

are integrated, and technology is embedded across operations. Unless students understand this environment, they will struggle to remain relevant.

A general management MBA without an understanding of technology will have a limited scope in the future. Management programmes must, therefore, align with industry requirements. Globally, the demand for traditional MBA programmes has been changing, and the placement patterns we saw earlier may not remain the same in the coming years. At IIM Lucknow, we are consciously discussing the future landscape and adapting our curriculum.

For a long time, IIMs focused primarily on high-quality MBA programmes. However, the changing environment requires institutions to think differently. That is why IIM Lucknow has introduced a four-year BS programme in Artificial Intelligence and Business Analytics. Some may ask why an IIM is offering a programme that appears closer to technology. But AI is not just a technology discipline like mechanical, civil or chemical engineering. It is also a business technology and a management technology. The objective is to develop capabilities across areas such as computer vision, cybersecurity, real-time business simulation and natural language processing.

This approach will help us create graduates who are innovators and entrepreneurs. Looking at the future of jobs and the changing nature of the economy, we may see growth without a proportional increase in traditional employment opportunities. With Industry 4.0 and increased automation, the demand will increasingly be for innovators, thinkers and creators rather than only job seekers.

Our programme has been designed with this vision. Students will be encouraged to think about business opportunities, create new ventures and develop ideas with mentorship and laboratory support. We are also redesigning our MBA offerings. We are introducing a Tech MBA programme.

The objective of the Tech MBA is to create business leaders who understand technology-driven companies. For example, a general MBA graduate joining companies such as IBM, Microsoft or Google may require time to adapt, whereas a Tech MBA graduate would be better aligned with the requirements of such organisations.

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How has your background and experience influenced your thinking about the future of management education in India?

One of my strong beliefs is that the future of standalone B-schools is limited. Over the past two to three decades, many standalone B-schools emerged to meet the needs of a growing economy and expanding businesses. However, technology has deeply influenced businesses and changed leadership requirements. The leaders of the future will require a much broader understanding.